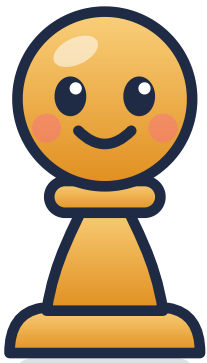


TAKE-HOME MAP

The Italian Game.

Mishika's map of every line we played, board by board.



PIP SAYS

Hi Mishika! I'm Pip. This is every line from our class. Read one map a day and say the moves out loud.

1

One board, one step

Each board shows the position after the moves written on top.

2

Yellow = last move

The yellow squares show the move that was just played.

3

Paths

When the game can go different ways, the map splits into Path A, Path B and so on.

INSIDE



Start

The first moves, and Black's three answers.



Two Knights

3...Nf6: the Fried Liver, the ...Na5 defence and the Nc3 trick.



Quiet Italian

4.d3: the coach's 13-move win and Magnus's game.



3...h6

3...h6 wastes a move. White hits the centre.



Evans Gambit

4.b4: White gives a pawn to attack fast.

Start

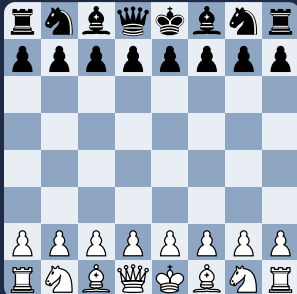
7 boards



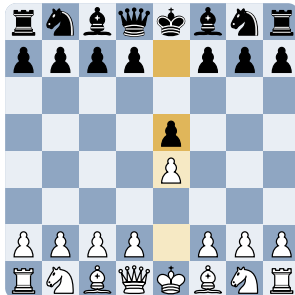
PIP SAYS

Every board is one step of the game. Read the boards left to right, then pick a path.

START HERE
New game

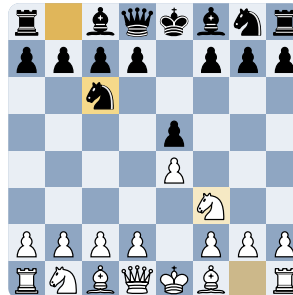


1.e4 e5



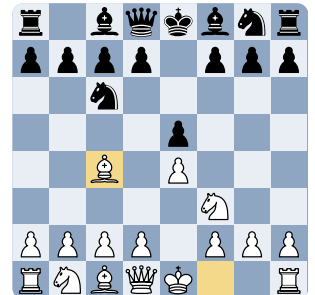
Both sides grab the middle with a pawn.

2.Nf3 Nc6



White's knight attacks e5. Black's knight guards it.

3.Bc4

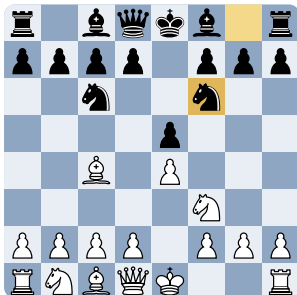


This is the Italian! The bishop stares at f7. Only Black's king guards that square.

Three ways to go from here.

Path A If Black plays

3...Nf6

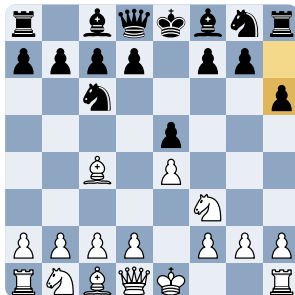


Black brings a knight out and hits e4.

Next: the Two Knights map

Path B If Black plays

3...h6?!

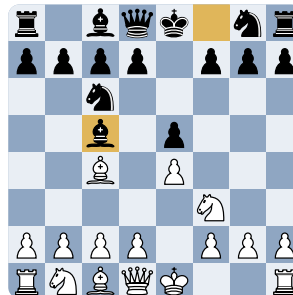


Black stops Ng5, but wastes a move.

Next: the 3...h6 map

Path C If Black plays

3...Bc5



Black's bishop copies White and aims at f2.

Next: the Evans Gambit map

Two Knights

7 lines · 34 boards

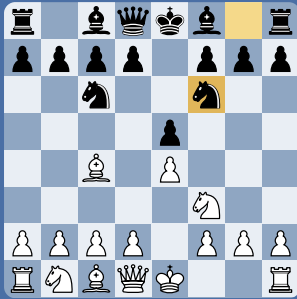


PIP SAYS

Black played 3...Nf6. Now White can jump at f7 right away!

START HERE

3...Nf6



Three ways to go from here.

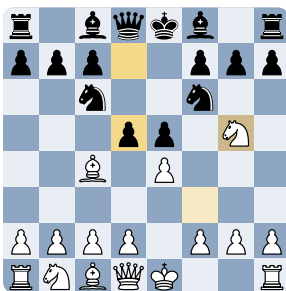
A 4.Ng5!

B 4.Nc3?!

C 4.d3

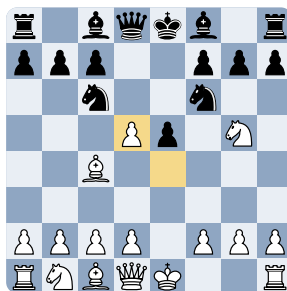
Path A If White plays 4.Ng5!

4.Ng5! d5



The knight jumps to g5 and eyes f7. Black blocks the bishop with d5.

5.exd5



White takes the pawn. Now Black has to choose.

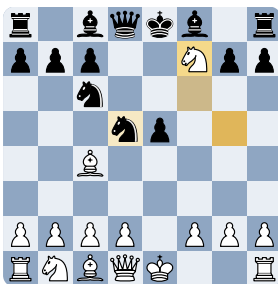
Two ways to go from here.

A1 5...Nxd5?

A2 5...Na5!

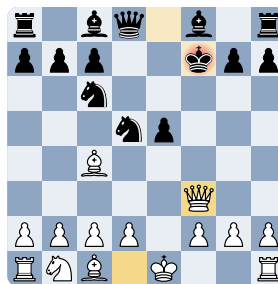
Path A1 If Black plays 5...Nxd5?

5...Nxd5? 6.Nxf7!



Oops! Taking back lets White's knight crash into f7. It hits the queen and the rook.

6...Kxf7 7.Qf3+



The king has to take. Now the queen checks and hits d5 too. Where should the king go?

Three ways to go from here.

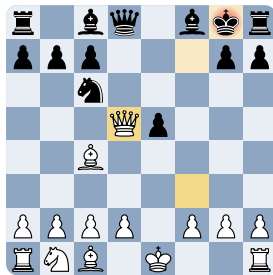
A1a 7...Kg8??

A1b 7...Ke8?

A1c 7...Ke6

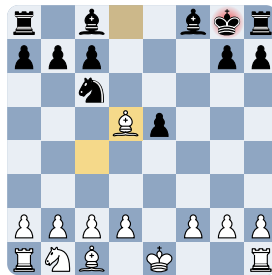
Path A1a If Black plays 7...Kg8??

7...Kg8?? 8.Qxd5+!



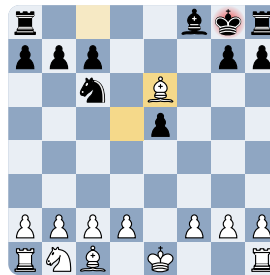
Big mistake! The king hides on g8, so the queen grabs d5 with check.

8...Qxd5 9.Bxd5+



Black trades queens, but the bishop takes back with check.

9...Be6 10.Bxe6#



Black blocks with the bishop. Bxe6 is checkmate!

Checkmate! White wins

Path A1b If Black plays 7...Ke8?

7...Ke8? 8.Bxd5!



Oops! The king runs home, and White wins the knight back. White is way ahead.

White wins 100%

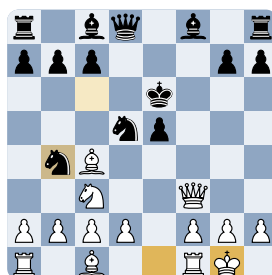
Path A1c If Black plays 7...Ke6

7...Ke6 8.Nc3!



The bravest try. The king guards d5 itself, so White adds a third attacker.

8...Nb4 9.O-O!



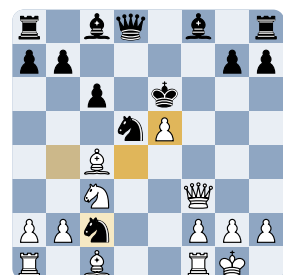
Black guards d5 again and eyes c2. White just castles.

9...c6 10.d4!



Black props up d5 with a pawn. White opens lines at the king.

10...Nxc2? 11.dxe5



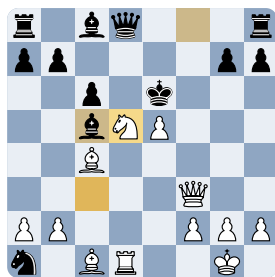
Greedy! Black grabs a pawn and attacks the rook. White keeps attacking.

11...Nxa1 12.Rd1!



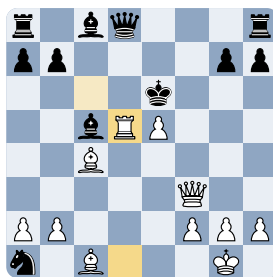
Black has grabbed a lot of pieces. But White's other rook joins the attack on d5.

12...Bc5 13.Nxd5



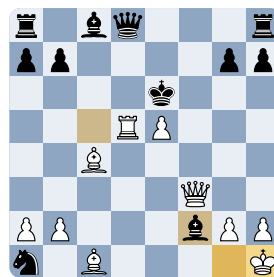
White's knight takes on d5 and breaks Black's wall.

13...cxd5 14.Rxd5!



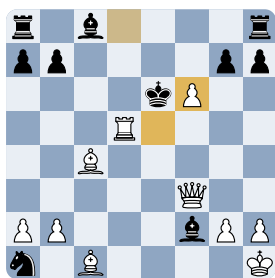
The rook takes on d5. Now every rook move is a sneaky check from the bishop.

14...Bxf2+ 15.Kh1



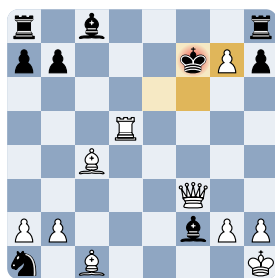
The video stops here, so I'll show you the best moves. Black checks and White's king steps aside.

15...Qf6 16.exf6



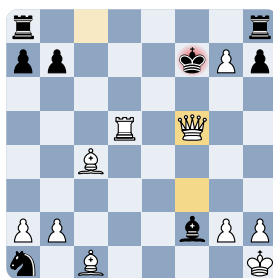
Black gives up the queen to slow White down. It doesn't help.

16...Kf7 17.fxg7+



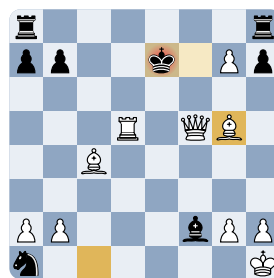
White's pawn keeps pushing with check.

17...Bf5 18.Qxf5+



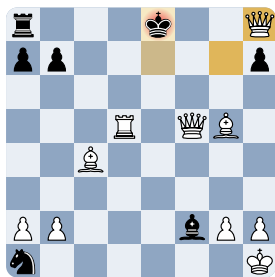
The queen takes the bishop with check. The black king is running out of room.

18...Ke7 19.Bg5+



Another check from the bishop. Almost there!

19...Ke8 20.gxh8=Q#

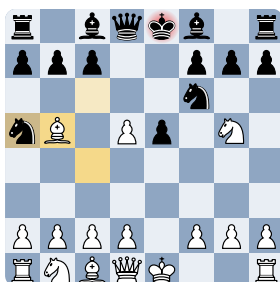


The pawn turns into a queen and it's checkmate!

Checkmate! White wins

Path A2 If Black plays 5...Na5!

5...Na5! 6.Bb5+



Nice! Black attacks the bishop instead of taking on d5. White gives a check.

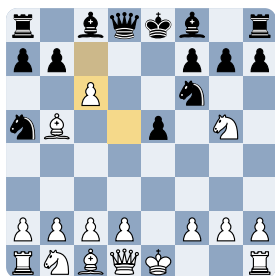
Two ways to go from here.

A2a 6...c6

A2b 6...Bd7

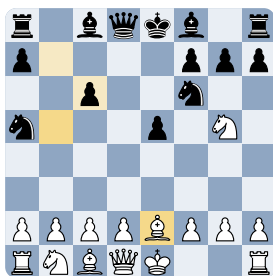
Path A2a If Black plays 6...c6

6...c6 7.dxc6



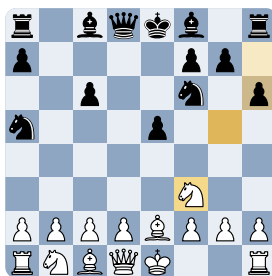
Black blocks with a pawn and lets White take it.

7...bxc6 8.Be2



Black is a pawn down, but the pieces come out fast.

8...h6 9.Nf3



Black kicks the knight back.

9...e4 10.Ne5

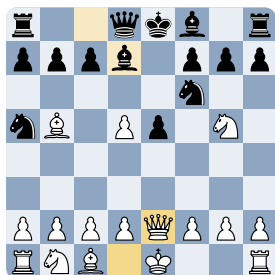


Black's busy pieces make up for the pawn. Even game.

Draw 97%

Path A2b If Black plays 6...Bd7

6...Bd7 7.Qe2



Black blocks with the bishop instead. That works too. Even game.

Draw 93%

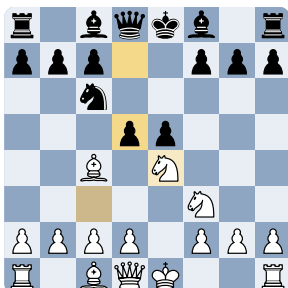
Path B If White plays 4.Nc3?!

4.Nc3?! Nxe4!



Oops! White guards e4 with a knight, and Black takes it anyway. It's a trick!

5.Nxe4 d5!



White takes back, but the d5 pawn attacks the bishop and the knight.

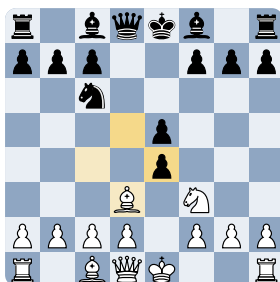
Two ways to go from here.

B1 6.Bd3!

B2 6.Bxd5?

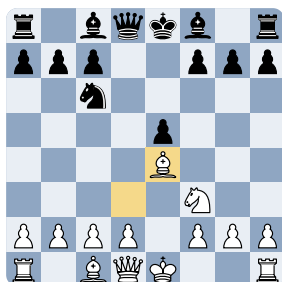
Path B1 If White plays 6.Bd3!

6.Bd3! dxe4



Good! White saves the bishop. Black gets the knight back.

7.Bxe4

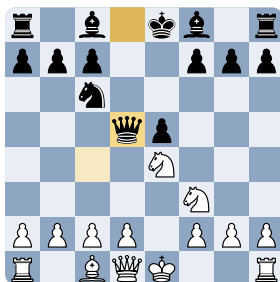


White takes back too. Even game.

Draw 98%

Path B2 If White plays 6.Bxd5?

6.Bxd5? Qxd5

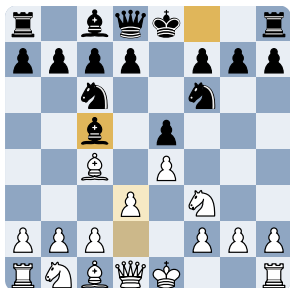


Oops! Giving up the bishop leaves Black with two bishops. Black is better.

Black wins 89%

Path C If White plays 4.d3

4.d3 Bc5



White guards e4 with a pawn. Quiet, but strong.

Next: the Quiet Italian map

Quiet Italian

6 lines · 35 boards

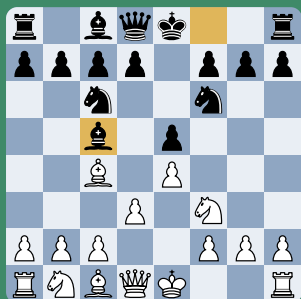


PIP SAYS

White played the calm 4.d3. Now White picks the knight to c3 or the pawn to c3.

START HERE

4...Bc5



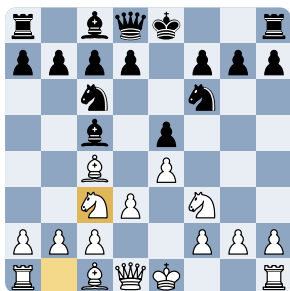
Two ways to go from here.

A 5.Nc3

B 5.c3

Path A If White plays 5.Nc3

5.Nc3



Knight to c3. This setup is called the Giuoco Pianissimo.

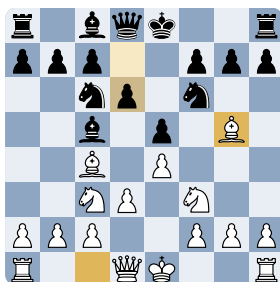
Two ways to go from here.

A1 5...d6

A2 5...h6

Path A1 If Black plays 5...d6

5...d6 6.Bg5



The bishop pins the f6 knight to the queen. Next White wants Nd5.

Two ways to go from here.

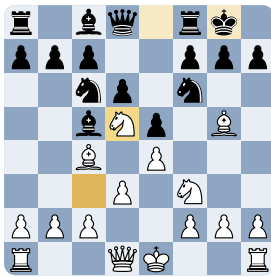
A1a 6...O-O?!

A1b 6...Be6!

Path A1a

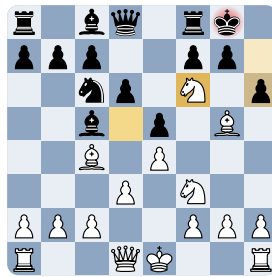
If Black plays 6...O-O?!

6...O-O?! 7.Nd5!



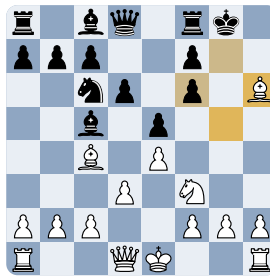
Castling looks normal, but now Nd5 hits the pinned knight again.

7...h6? 8.Nxf6+!



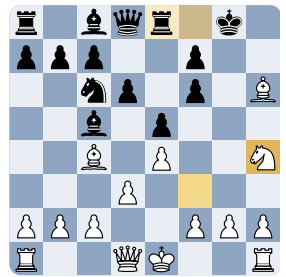
Oops! Black kicks the bishop, but White takes on f6 with check first.

8...gxf6 9.Bxh6



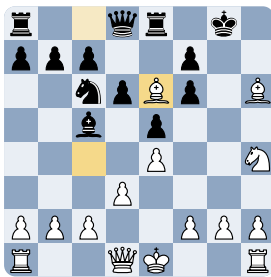
The g-pawn had to take, so h6 is free. The bishop grabs it.

9...Re8 10.Nh4



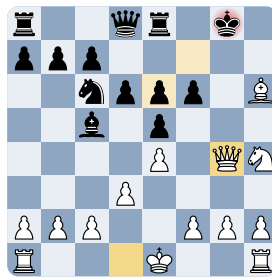
The rook runs away. The knight steps aside so the queen can come to g4.

10...Be6? 11.Bxe6



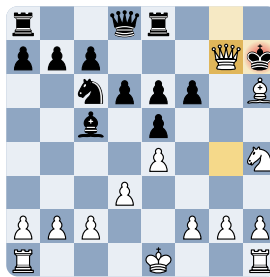
Oops! Black offers a bishop trade. Once it's gone, nothing guards g4.

11...fxe6 12.Qg4+



The queen jumps to g4 with check.

12...Kh7 13.Qg7#



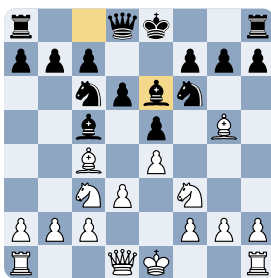
Checkmate! The queen and the bishop on h6 work together.

Checkmate! White wins

Path A1b

If Black plays 6...Be6!

6...Be6!



Good defence! If a knight comes to d5, Black can trade it off.

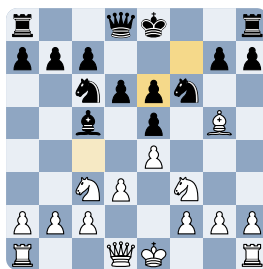
Two ways to go from here.

A1b1 7.Bxe6

A1b2 7.Nd5

Path A1b1 If White plays 7.Bxe6

7.Bxe6 fxe6



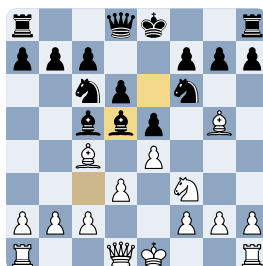
Black gets two pawns on one file, but they guard the middle. Even game.



Draw 96%

Path A1b2 If White plays 7.Nd5

7.Nd5 Bxd5

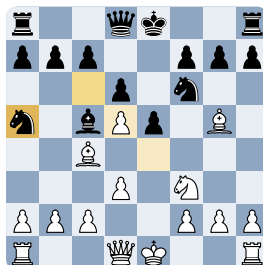


The knight comes anyway, so Black's bishop takes it.

Two ways to go from here.

Path A1b2a If White plays

8.exd5 Na5



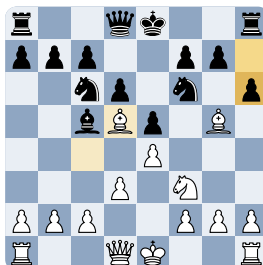
The pawn takes back and the knight hops away. Even game.



Draw 96%

Path A1b2b If White plays

8.Bxd5 h6



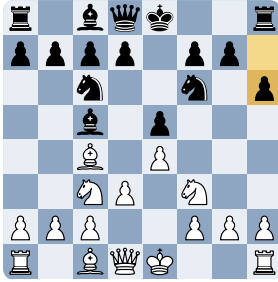
The bishop takes back and Black kicks the other bishop. Even game.



Draw 94%

Path A2 If Black plays 5...h6

5...h6



Smart! Black stops Bg5 before it happens.

Draw 96%

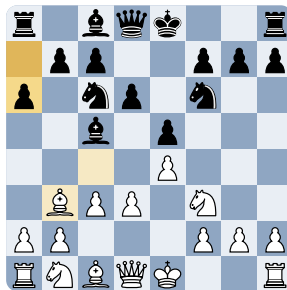
Path B If White plays 5.c3

5.c3 d6



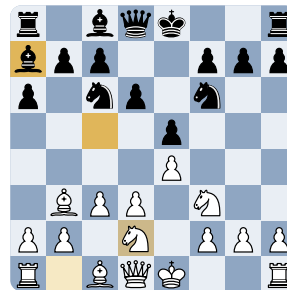
Pawn to c3. This is the Giuoco Piano. White wants to push d4 later.

6.Bb3 a6



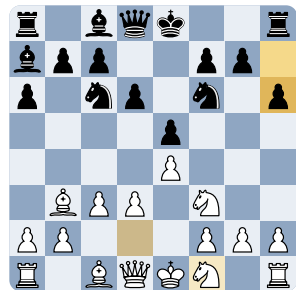
This is Magnus Carlsen's game! His bishop steps back to b3 where it's safe.

7.Nbd2 Ba7



The knight can't use c3, so it starts a trip to g3.

8.Nf1 h6



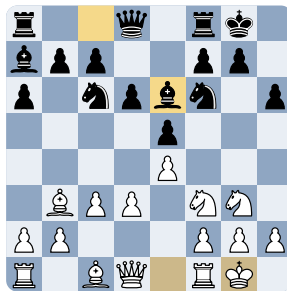
Knight to f1. Next stop, g3!

9.Ng3 O-O



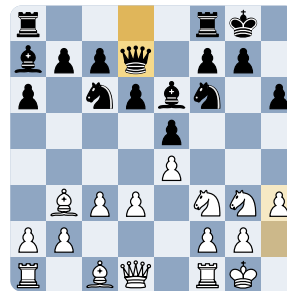
From g3 the knight looks at f5 and Black's king.

10.O-O Be6



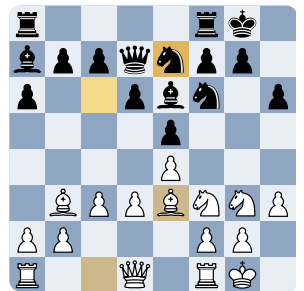
Both kings are safe. Black offers to trade bishops.

11.h3 Qd7



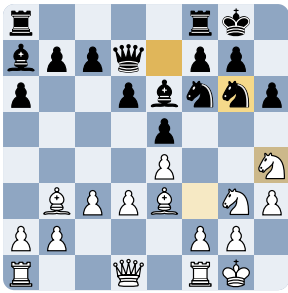
Magnus says no thanks. Black's queen and bishop now aim at h3.

12.Be3 Ne7



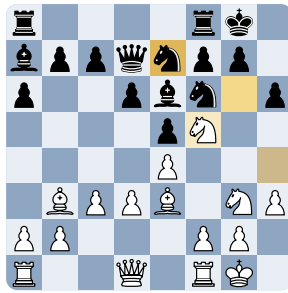
White offers a bishop trade back. Black's knight heads for g6.

13.Nh4 Ng6



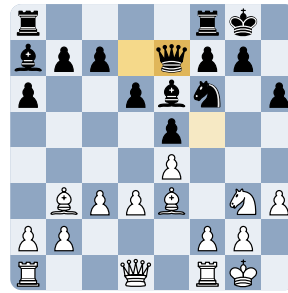
White's second knight comes over to help on f5.

14.Nhf5 Ne7



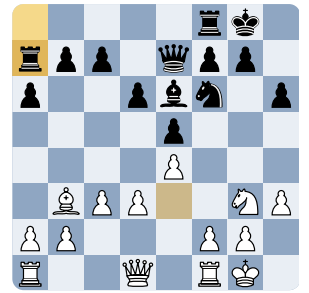
A knight lands on f5. Black wants to swap it off.

15.Nxe7+ Qxe7



The knights come off the board.

16.Bxa7 Rxa7



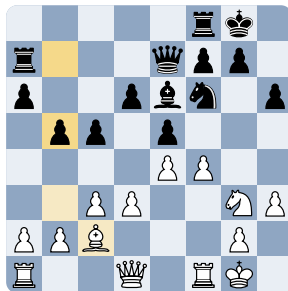
The bishops come off too.

17.f4! c5



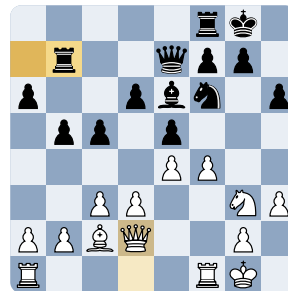
No d4 yet! White opens the f-file. Black attacks on the other side.

18.Bc2 b5



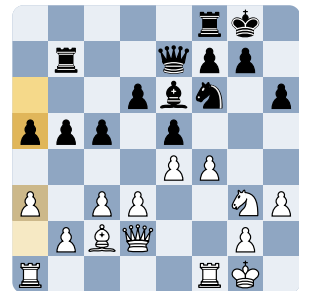
The bishop looks stuck, but later it will aim at h7.

19.Qd2 Rb7



Both sides get their pieces ready.

20.a3 a5



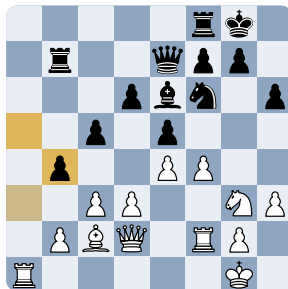
The pawns face off on the queenside.

21.Rf2 b4



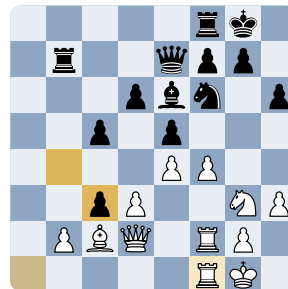
White lines up the rooks on the f-file.

22.axb4 axb4



The pawns trade.

23.Raf1 bxc3



The map stops here and it's still even. Magnus wins later with a rook sacrifice!

The game goes on...

Draw 98%

3...h6

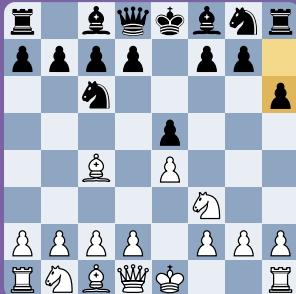
2 lines · 13 boards



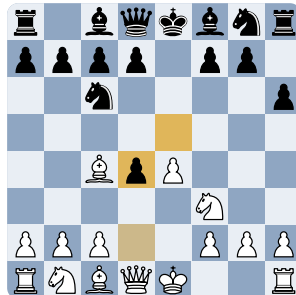
PIP SAYS

Black played 3...h6. It stops Ng5, but no new piece came out.

START HERE
3...h6?!

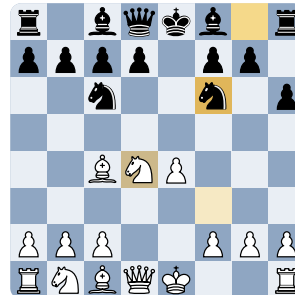


4.d4! exd4



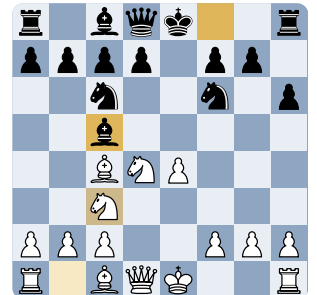
White hits the middle right away.

5.Nxd4 Nf6



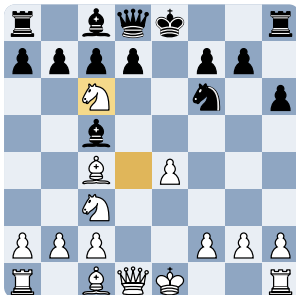
White takes back. Black finally brings a knight out.

6.Nc3 Bc5



Now Black attacks White's d4 knight twice.

7.Nxc6



So White trades it off.

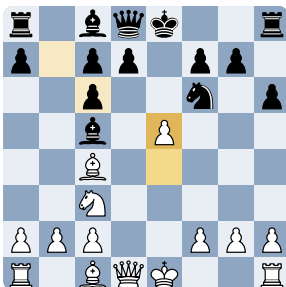
Two ways to go from here.

A 7...bxc6

B 7...dxc6

Path A If Black plays 7...bxc6

7...bxc6 8.e5!



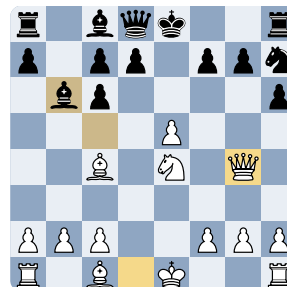
White's pawn kicks the f6 knight. It can only go to h7 or g8.

8...Nh7 9.Ne4



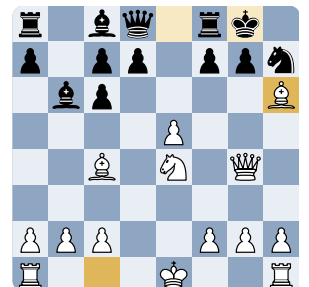
White's knight hits Black's bishop.

9...Bb6 10.Qg4!



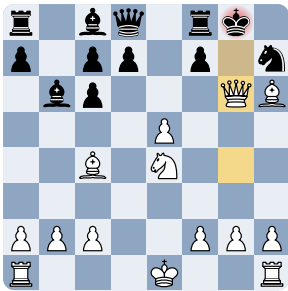
The queen hits g7. Careful, Black!

10...O-O? 11.Bxh6!



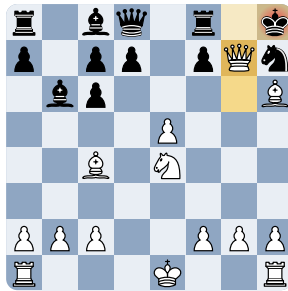
Oops! Black castles, so the bishop takes h6. Next is Qxg7, checkmate.

11...g6 12.Qxg6+



The queen crashes in with check.

12...Kh8 13.Qg7#



Checkmate! It's the same trick as the coach's win in the Quiet Italian.

Checkmate! White wins

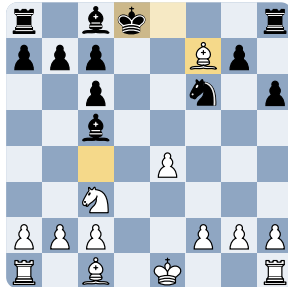
Path B If Black plays 7...dxc6

7...dxc6 8.Qxd8+



Black takes back the other way. White trades queens with check.

8...Kxd8 9.Bxf7



White wins a pawn, and Black's king can't castle anymore.

White wins 100%

Evans Gambit

6 lines · 35 boards



PIP SAYS

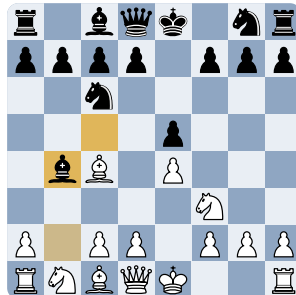
Black played 3...Bc5. Now White can try a cool pawn sacrifice!

START HERE

3...Bc5

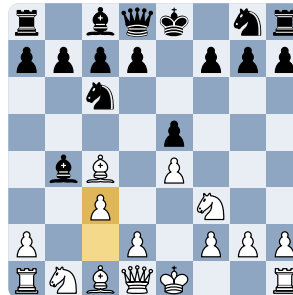


4.b4!? Bxb4



This is the Evans Gambit!
White gives a pawn to win time.

5.c3



White hits the bishop and gets ready for d4.

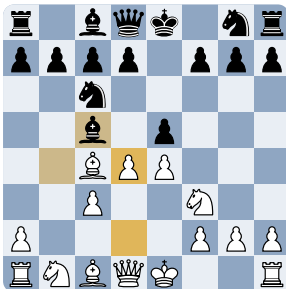
Two ways to go from here.

A 5...Bc5

B 5...Ba5

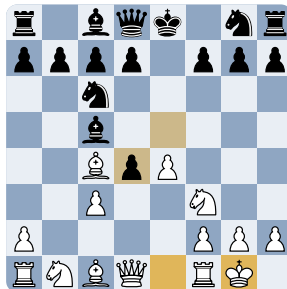
Path A If Black plays 5...Bc5

5...Bc5 6.d4



The bishop runs back. White pushes into the middle.

6...exd4 7.O-O!

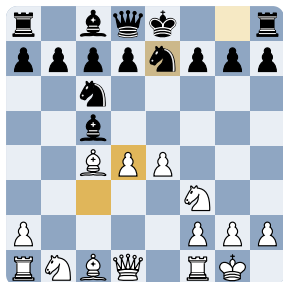


Black takes. White castles first and takes back later.

A3 7...Nge7

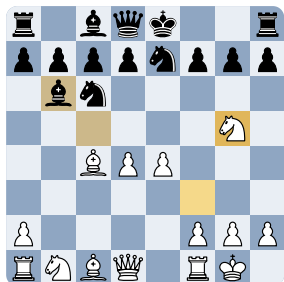
Path A3 If Black plays 7...Nge7

7...Nge7 8.cxd4



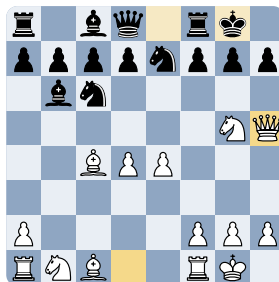
Black puts the knight on e7, so a pawn can't kick it.

8...Bb6 9.Ng5!



The knight jumps to g5 and aims at f7 again.

9...O-O? 10.Qh5!



Oops! Black castles, and the queen makes two threats at once.

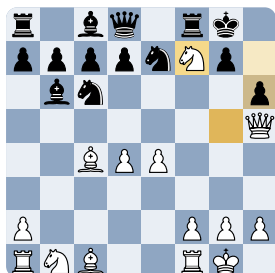
Two ways to go from here.

A3a 10...h6

A3b 10...Re8

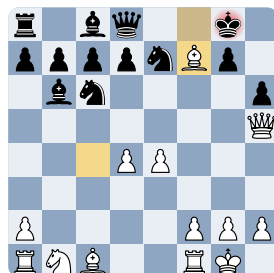
Path A3a If Black plays 10...h6

10...h6 11.Nxf7



Black stops the mate, so White takes on f7.

11...Rxf7 12.Bxf7+

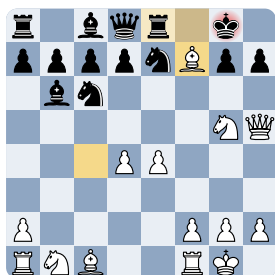


White wins a rook for a knight, plus a pawn.

White wins 100%

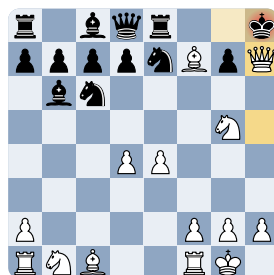
Path A3b If Black plays 10...Re8

10...Re8 11.Bxf7+



Black guards with the rook. The bishop takes f7 with check.

11...Kh8 12.Qxh7#

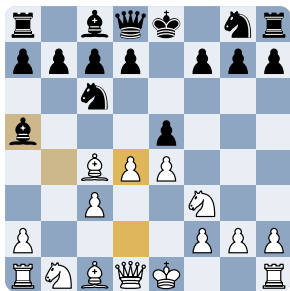


Checkmate on h7!

Checkmate! White wins

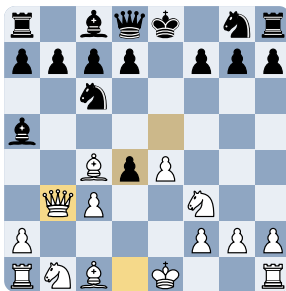
Path B If Black plays 5...Ba5

5...Ba5 6.d4



The bishop pins the c3 pawn. White pushes d4 anyway.

6...exd4 7.Qb3!



The c3 pawn can't take back, so the queen goes after f7.

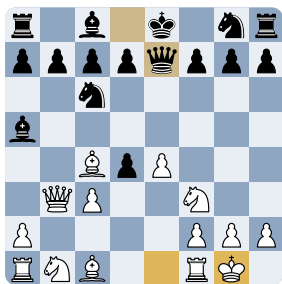
Two ways to go from here.

B1 7...Qe7

B2 7...Nh6

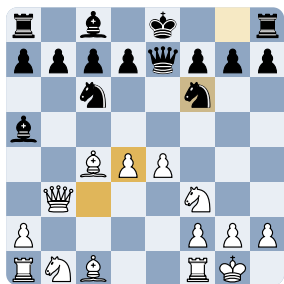
Path B1 If Black plays 7...Qe7

7...Qe7 8.O-O



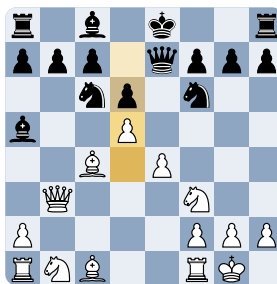
Black's queen guards f7. White castles.

8...Nf6 9.cxd4



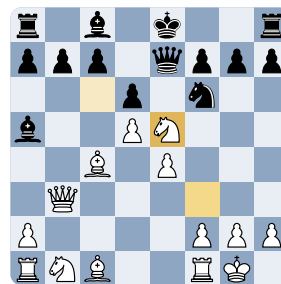
Black brings a knight out. White takes back on d4.

9...d6? 10.d5!



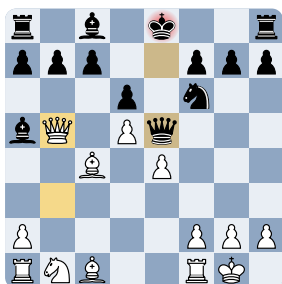
Oops! Black stops e5, but White's d5 chases the knight away. Soon the a5 bishop has no guard.

10...Ne5 11.Nxe5



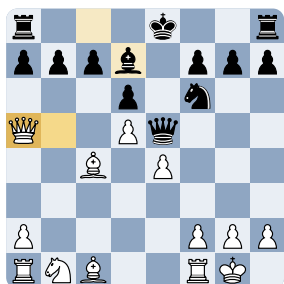
The knights trade on e5.

11...Qxe5 12.Qb5+!



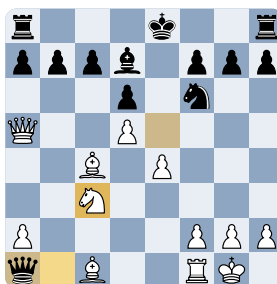
Black's queen hits the rook. White gives a check first.

12...Bd7 13.Qxa5



White wins the bishop on a5.

13...Qxa1? 14.Nc3!

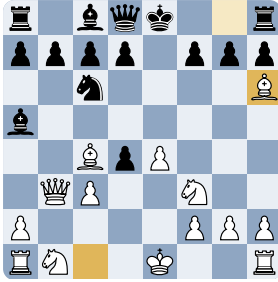


Oops! Black grabs the rook, but now the queen is trapped.

White wins 100%

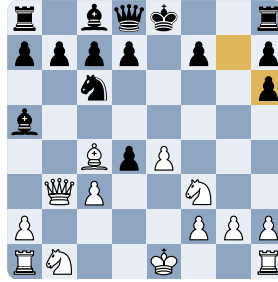
Path B2 If Black plays 7...Nh6

7...Nh6 8.Bxh6



Black's knight goes to h6, and White takes it.

8...gxh6



Black's pawns are broken and f7 is weak. It's still an even game.

Draw 93%

Five things to remember

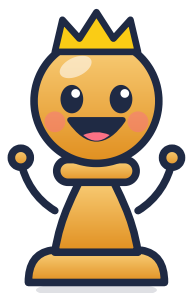
- 1 f7 is Black's weak spot.**
Only the king guards it. Ng5, Bxf7 and Qh5 all go after it.
- 2 Bring your pieces out.**
Don't push pawns for nothing. 3...h6 wastes a move and White hits the centre.
- 3 Guard e4 with a pawn.**
Play d3, not Nc3. After Nc3, Black can play ...Nxe4 and the ...d5 fork.
- 4 In a gambit, castle first.**
Take your pawn back later. A safe king is worth more than one pawn.
- 5 Queen on the g-file, pawn on h6?**
Look for Bxh6! It wins in the 3...h6 line and in the coach's 13-move game.

Practise at home

- Open the Elvyn app and go to My learning.
- Play the Italian Game levels until every line has 3 stars.
- Set up one board from this map and play it against someone at home.

Before our next class

- Pick your favourite line and learn it by heart.
- Find the move with "Oops!" in each map. Can you say why it's a mistake?
- Bring one question about the Evans Gambit.



PIP SAYS

Great work, Mishika! Every queen was once a pawn.

See you in class,
Coach Akshat
Elvyn Chess